

FALL ARTS 2025

A GREAT SEASON FOR BOOKS

Your reading list should expect company, regardless of whether you like mysteries or harrowing memoirs. Fall is a cornucopia. **A+E**



STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

LIFE+TRAVEL

Not *that* magic school

The Junior Society at the Academy of Magical Arts in Los Angeles is home to young magicians from around the world who are passionate about their craft.

REAL ESTATE

The games we play

Real estate has long been embedded into play, but now games like Monopoly and Life have taken on new meaning. They can teach us about real-life ownership.

Ill. carbon capture project raises fears

Proximity to aquifer has some worried about water contamination

By Lily Carey
Chicago Tribune

A little over three years ago, a representative from ethanol manufacturer One Earth Energy knocked on Sally Lasser's door. The representative, who Lasser said was "a dear neighbor," told her his company was working on a new project to cut down its carbon footprint and handed her a yellow envelope, containing information about a complex technology called carbon capture and sequestration. In the manufacturing process, carbon dioxide is filtered out of the air, converted into its liquid form, transported offsite via pipelines, and then stored nearly a mile underground. "At first, I thought nothing of it," said Lasser, who owns a farm just outside Gibson City in central Illinois. "I read it. I didn't understand it. I put it aside."

Carbon capture isn't new, but in recent years it's been gaining popularity among fuel manufacturers and policymakers. Producing natural gas, oil or ethanol typically leads to a lot of carbon emissions, so companies such as ExxonMobil, Shell and Chevron see carbon capture as a way to lessen their environmental impact without significantly changing the way they make their fuel.

But if carbon dioxide leaks out of an underground well or an above-ground pipeline, it could be dangerous to humans, and companies pursuing carbon capture haven't always reported leaks. One Earth is looking to inject its CO2 just outside the borders of the Mahomet Aquifer, the main source of water for over 800,000 central Illinoisans in 14 counties.

Though leaks are extremely rare, some people, including Lasser, are afraid of their groundwater being contaminated — and afraid of trusting ethanol companies to keep that water safe.

Turn to Project, Page 14



Lina Alvarez, a retired U.S. Army sergeant first class, reacts to the support of a passing motorist as she protests in front of the main gate at Naval Station Great Lakes on Wednesday in North Chicago. During her 21 years of active duty, she was deployed four times to the Middle East. With the expanded rights of immigration agents, Alvarez is asking, "Why should I have to prove I'm American?" **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Immigration 'blitz' has suburbs pushing back

Trump's enforcement threats spark protests outside hotels and a naval base

By Jonathan Bullington and Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

She got to the base's main gate at 6:30 a.m. Wednesday, dressed in her Army boots and a red and black dress adorned with embroidered flowers, one of two identical dresses she and her daughter received from her aunt on a family trip to Guadalajara.

The boots, she said, were for confidence, the dress to symbolize her Mexican heritage.

Lina Alvarez spearheaded a protest outside Naval Station Great Lakes on Sept. 6 that drew

IN CHICAGOLAND: Outside ICE facility, allies of detained day laborer call for his release. **Page 3**

■ Elgin council to adopt resolution demanding ICE agents be unmasked. **Page 3**

■ Flower vendor arrested at launch of "Operation Midway Blitz" deported to Mexico. **Page 10**

hundreds of people opposed to its use as a base of operations for President Donald Trump's planned immigration "blitz" on Chicago.

Four days later, the 42-year-old retired U.S. Army sergeant

first class returned to the North Chicago base alone, carrying two flags — American and Mexican — bound together as one and a poster board on which she wrote in green marker:

*IMAGINE
4 deployments
IEDs
Small arms fire
Indirect fire
Soldier's suicide
PTSD*

But I must prove I'm American when they ask?

"I came here to be a voice for people who are too scared to come out here," Alvarez said.

"I came here to try to make the world a little bit safer for my daughter. I came here because last Saturday was the first time I felt a little bit of hope."

While the Trump administration has singled out Chicago for immigration sweeps this month — dubbed "Operation Midway Blitz" — and a possible National Guard deployment aimed, he's said, at curbing the city's endemic crime, those threats have stirred considerable pushback from residents and leaders across the suburbs who have orga-

Turn to Protests, Page 4

Complaints in limbo after closure of civil rights office



Mollie McGuire and her son spend time together at their home in Chicago after school on Sept. 5. McGuire's son experienced anxiety attacks at his former school and was diagnosed with autism, but school officials repeatedly denied him access to an Individualized Education Plan. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Dept. of Education redirected Midwest cases to Denver office

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Some days, Mollie McGuire wondered if her then 7-year-old son was dying.

The wide-eyed boy, who once raced off to school, came home from class and hid in his room. He barely spoke to his parents. For months, he ate only a handful of select foods and would experience sudden onsets of anxiety, sobbing and gasping for air.

Staff at James Otis Elementary School in West Town struggled to navigate his frequent panic attacks, according to records reviewed by the Tribune.

After her son was repeatedly denied an Individualized Education Plan — a legal document that would provide him access

to special education resources — McGuire said she filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Education's Office for Civil Rights.

She was scheduled to meet with an OCR attorney in January. Then President Donald Trump was inaugurated, and the meeting never came.

Under the direction of Trump officials, work on complaints effectively ground to a halt. By March, the Department of Education's civil rights office in Chicago was among seven regional branches abruptly closed — part of a sprawling push to dismantle the agency.

The shutdown was swift, and the fallout staggering. Midwest cases were redirected to the agency's Denver office, where just over a dozen investigative attorneys were soon stacked with more than 4,200 cases,

Turn to Closure, Page 2

INSIDE



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/TRIBUNE

Johnson's return to Detroit the storyline

The Bears and Lions renew their rivalry Sunday, and the coaching change is sure to dominate the narrative. **Chicago Sports**

Health insurance subsidies in peril

There's bipartisan support for extending tax credits, but they may expire as GOP, Democrats clash over how to do it. **Nation & World**

